Syllabus errorum

Pius IX · English

THE SYLLABUS OF PIUS IX

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Syllabus of the principal errors of our time, which are censured in the consistorial Allocu tions, Encyclical and other Apostolical Let ters of our Most Holy Lord, Pope Pius IX.

PANTHEISM, NATURALISM AND ABSOLUTE RATIONALISM

1. There exists no Supreme, all-wise, all- provident Divine Being, distinct from the uni verse, and God is identical with the nature of things, and is, therefore, subject to changes. In effect, God is produced in man and in the world, and all things are God and have the very substance of God, and God is one and the same thing with the world, and, therefore, spirit with matter, necessity with liberty, good with evil, justice with injustice. — Allocution "Maxima quidem" June 9, 1862.

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2. All action of God upon man and the world is to be denied. — Ibid.

3. Human reason, without any reference whatsoever to God, is the sole arbiter of truth and falsehood, and of good and evil; it is law to itself, and suffices, by its natural force, to secure the welfare of men and of nations. — Ibid.

4. All the truths of religion proceed from the innate strength of human reason; hence reason is the ultimate standard by which man can and ought to arrive at the knowledge of all truths of every kind. — Ibid.j and Encyclical ffQui pluribus" Nov. 9, 1846 1 etc.

5. Divine revelation is imperfect, and therefore subject to a continual and indefinite progress, corresponding with the advancement of human reason. — Ibid.

6. The faith of Christ is in opposition to human reason, and divine revelation not only is not useful, but is even hurtful to the perfec tion of man. — Ibid.

7. The prophecies and miracles set forth and recorded in the Sacred Scriptures are the fiction of poets, and the mysteries of the

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Christian faith the result of philosophical in vestigations. In the books of the Old and the New Testament there are contained mythical inventions, and Jesus Christ is Himself a myth. — Ibid.

II

MODERATE RATIONALISM

8. As human reason is placed on a level with religion itself, so theological must be treated in the same manner as philosophical sciences. — Allocution "Singulari quadam" Dec. 9, 1854.

9. All the dogmas of the Christian religion are indiscriminately the object of natural sci ence or philosophy; and human reason, enlight ened solely in an historical way, is able, by its own natural strength and principles, to attain to the true science of even the most abstruse dogmas; provided only that such dogmas be proposed to reason itself as its object. — Let ters to the Archbishop of Munich, "Gravis- simas inter" Dec. 11, 1862, and ff Tuas liben- ter" Dec. 21, 1863.

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10. As the philosopher is one thing, and philosophy another, so it is the right and duty of the philosopher to subject himself to the authority which he shall have proved to be true; but philosophy neither can nor ought to submit to any such authority. — Ibid., Dec. 11, 1862.

11. The Church not only ought never to pass judgment on philosophy, but ought to tol erate the errors of philosophy, leaving it to cor rect itself .—Ibid., Dec. 21, 1863.

12. The decrees of the Apostolic See and of the Roman congregations impede the true progress of science. — Ibid.

13. The method and principles by which the old scholastic doctors cultivated theology are no longer suitable to the demands of our times and to the progress of the sciences.— Ibid.

14. Philosophy is to be treated without tak ing any account of supernatural revelation.— Ibid.

N. B. To the rationalistic system belong in great part the errors of Anthony Giinther, condemned in the letter to the Cardinal Arch-

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bishop of Cologne, "Eximiam tuam," June 15, 1857, and in that to the Bishop of Breslau, "Dolore haud mediocri," April 30, 1860.

Ill

INDIFFERENTISM. LATITUDINARIANISM

15. Every man is free to embrace and pro fess that religion which, guided by the light of reason, he shall consider true. — Allocution "Maxima quidem" June 9, 1862; Damnatio "Multiplices inter" June 10, 1851.

16. Man may, in the observance of any re ligion whatever, find the way of eternal salva tion, and arrive at eternal salvation. — En cyclical ffQui pluribus" Nov.

9, 1846.

17. Good hope at least is to be entertained of the eternal salvation of all those who are not at all in the true Church of Christ. — Encyclical "Quanto conficiamur," Aug. 10, 1863, etc.

18. Protestantism is nothing more than another form of the same true Christian re ligion, in which form it is given to please God equally as in the Catholic Church. — Encycli cal "Noscitis" Dec. 8, 1849.

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IV

SOCIALISM, COMMUNISM, SECRET SOCIETIES, BIBLICAL SOCIETIES, CLERICO-LIB-ERAL SOCIETIES

Pests of this kind are frequently reprobated in the severest terms in the Encyclical "Qui pluribus," Nov. 9, 1846, Allocution "Quibus quantisque," April 20, 1849, Encyclical "No- scitis et nobiscum," Dec. 8, 1849, Allocution "Singular! quadam," Dec. 9, 1854, Encyclical "Quanto conficiamur," Aug. 10, 1863.

ERRORS CONCERNING THE CHURCH AND HER RIGHTS

19. The Church is not a true and perfect society, entirely free; nor is she endowed with proper and perpetual rights of her own, con ferred upon her by her Divine Founder; but it appertains to the civil power to define what

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are the rights of the Church, and the limits within which she may exercise those rights. — Allocution "Singulari quadam," Dec. 9, 1854, etc.

20. The ecclesiastical power ought not to exercise its authority without the permission and assent of the civil government. — Allocu tion "Meminit unusquisque," Sept. 30, 1861.

21. The Church has not the power of de fining dogmatically that the religion of the Catholic Church is the only true religion. — Damnatio "Multiplies inter" June 10, 1851.

22. The obligation by which Catholic teachers and authors are strictly bound is con fined to those things only which are proposed to universal belief as dogmas of faith by the infallible judgment of the Church. — Letter to the Archbishop of Munich, "Tuas libenter" Dec. 21, 1863.

23. Roman pontiffs and oecumenical coun cils have wandered outside the limits of their powers, have usurped the rights of princes, and have even erred in defining matters of faith and morals. — Damnatio "Multiplices in ter" June 10, 1851.

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24. The Church has not the power of using force, nor has she any temporal power, direct or indirect. — Apostolic Letter "Ad Apostolicce" Aug. 22, 1851.

25. Besides the power inherent in the epis copate, other temporal power has been attrib uted to it by the civil authority, granted either explicitly or tacitly, which on that ac count is revocable by the civil authority when ever it thinks fit. — Ibid.

26. The Church has no innate and legiti mate right of acquiring and possessing prop erty. — Allocution "Nunquam fore" Dec. 15, 1856; Encyclical "Incredibili" Sept. 7, 1863.

27. The sacred ministers of the Church and the Roman pontiff are to be absolutely excluded from every charge and dominion over temporal affairs. — Allocution <(Maxima quidem" June 9, 1862.

28. It is not lawful for bishops to publish even letters Apostolic without the permis sion of Government. — Allocution "Nunquam fore" Dec. 15, 1856.

29. Favours granted by the Roman pontiff ought to be considered null, unless they have

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been sought for through the civil government. -Ibid.

30. The immunity of the Church and of ecclesiastical persons derived its origin from civil law. — Damnatio "Multiplies inter/' June 10, 1851.

31. The ecclesiastical forum or tribunal for the temporal causes, whether civil or crim inal, of clerics, ought by all means to be abol ished, even without consulting and against the protest of the Holy See. — Allocution "Nun- quam fore" Dec. IB, 1856; Allocution "Acer- bissimum" Sept. 27, 1852.

82. The personal immunity by which cler ics are exonerated from military conscription and service in the army may be abolished with out violation either of natural right or equity. Its abolition is called for by civil progress, es pecially in a society framed on the model of a liberal government. — Letter to the Bishop of Monreale "Singularis nobisque" Sept. 29, 1864.

33. It does not appertain exclusively to the power of ecclesiastical jurisdiction by right, proper and innate, to direct the teach-

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ing of theological questions. — Letter to the Archbishop of Munich, f(Tuas lib enter,33 Dec. 21, 1863.

34. The teaching of those who compare the Sovereign Pontiff to a prince, free and acting in the universal Church, is a doctrine which prevailed in the Middle Ages. — Apostolic Letter ffAd Apostolicce," Aug. 22, 1851.

35. There is nothing to prevent the de cree of a general council, or the act of all peo ples, from transferring the supreme pontifi cate from the bishop and city of Rome

to an other bishop and another city. — Ibid.

36. The definition of a national council does not admit of any subsequent discussion, and the civil authority can assume this prin ciple as the basis of its acts. — Ibid.

37. National churches, withdrawn from the authority of the Roman pontiff and al together separated, can be established. — Allo cution "Multis gravibusque," Dec. 17, 1860.

38. The Roman pontiffs have, by their too arbitrary conduct, contributed to the division of the Church into Eastern and Western. —

Apostolic Letter "Ad 'Apostolicce" \Aug. 22, 1851.

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ERRORS ABOUT CIVIL SOCIETY, CONSIDERED BOTH IN ITSELF AND IN ITS RELATION TO THE CHURCH

39. The State, as being the origin and source of all rights, is endowed with a certain right not circumscribed by any limits. — Allo cution "Maxima quidem" June 9, 1862.

40. The teaching of the Catholic Church is hostile to the well-being and interests of society. — Encyclical ffQui pluribus," Nov. 9, 1846; r Allocution "Quibus quantisque" rApril 20, 1849.

41. The civil government, even when in the hands of an infidel sovereign, has a right to an indirect negative power over religious affairs. It therefore possesses not only the right called that of eocsequatur, but also that of appeal, called appellatio ab dbusu. — Apos tolic Letter <(Ad Apostolicce" Aug. 22, 1851.

42. In the case of conflicting laws enacted by the two powers, the civil law prevails- — Ibid.

43. The secular power has authority to re scind, declare and render null, solemn conven tions, commonly called concordats, entered in to with the Apostolic See, regarding the use of rights appertaining to ecclesiastical immunity, without the consent of the Apostolic See, and even in spite of its protest. — Allocution "Mul- tis gravibusque" Dec. 17, 1860; Allocution "In consistoriali" Nov. 1, 1850.

44. The civil authority may interfere in matters relating to religion, morality and spir itual government: hence, it can pass judgment on the instructions issued for the guidance of consciences, conformably with their mission, by the pastors of the Church. Further, it has the right to make enactments regarding the administration of the divine sacraments, and the dispositions necessary for receiving them. —Allocutions "In consistoriali" Nov. 1, 1850,

and "Maxima quidem" June 9, 1862.

45. The entire government of public schools in which the youth of a Christian state is edu-

cated, except (to a certain extent) in the case of episcopal seminaries, may and ought to ap pertain to the civil power, and belong to it so far that no other authority whatsoever shall be recognized as having any right to interfere in the discipline of the schools, the arrangement of the studies, the conferring of degrees, in the choice or approval of the teachers. — Allo cutions "Quibus luctuosissimis" Sept. 5, 1851, and "In consistoriali" Nov. 13 1850.

46. Moreover, even in ecclesiastical semi naries, the method of studies to be adopted is subject to the civil authority. — Allocution "Nunquam fore" Dec. 15, 1856.

47. The best theory of civil society requires that popular schools open to children of every class of the people, and, generally, all public institutes intended for instruction in letters and philosophical sciences and for carrying on the education of youth, should be freed from all ecclesiastical authority, control and inter ference, and should be fully subjected to the civil and political power at the pleasure of the rulers, and according to the standard of the prevalent opinions of the age. — Epistle to the

Archbishop of Freiburg, "Cum non sine" July 14, 1864.

48. Catholics may approve of the system of educating youth, unconnected with Catholic faith and the power of the Church, and which regards the knowledge of merely natural things, and only, or at least primarily, the ends of earthly social life. — Ibid.

49. The civil power may prevent the prel ates of the Church and the faithful from com municating freely and mutually with the Ro man pontiff. — Allocution "Maxima quidem" June 9, 1862.

50. Lay authority possesses of itself the right of presenting bishops, and may require of them to undertake the administration of the diocese before they receive canonical institu tion, and the Letters Apostolic from the Holy See. — Allocution "Nunquam fore/' Dec. 15, 1856.

51. And, further, the lay government has the right of deposing bishops from their pas toral functions, and is not bound to obey the Roman pontiff in those things which relate to the institution of bishoprics and the appoint-

ment of bishops. — Allocution " Acerbissinmm" Sept. 27, 1852; Damnatio {(Multiplices inter" June 10, 1851.

52. Government can, by its own right, al ter the age prescribed by the Church for the religious profession of

women and men; and may require of all religious orders to admit no person to take solemn vows without its per mission. — Allocution "Nunquam fore" Dec. 15, 1856.

53. The laws enacted for the protection of religious orders and regarding their rights and duties ought to be abolished; nay, more, civil Government may lend its assistance to all who desire to renounce the obligation which they have undertaken of a religious life, and to break their vows^ Government may also ^sup press the said religious orders, as likewise col legiate churches and simple benefices, even those of advowson, and subject their property and revenues to the administration and pleas ure of the civil power. — Allocutions "Acerbis- simum," Sept. 27, 1852; "Probe memineritis," Jan. 22, 1855; "Cum saepe," July 26, 1855.

54. Kings and princes are not only exempt

from the jurisdiction of the Church, but are superior to the Church in deciding questions of jurisdiction. — Damnatio "Multiplices in ter" June 10, 1851.

55. The Church ought to be separated from the State, and the State from the Church. — Allocution "Acerbissimum" Sept. 27, 1852.

VII

ERRORS CONCERNING NATURAL AND CHRIS TIAN ETHICS

56. Moral laws do not stand in need of the divine sanction, and it is not at all neces sary that human laws should be made con formable to the laws of nature, and receive their power of binding from God. — Allocution "Maxima quidem" June 9, 1862.

57. The science of philosophical things and morals and also civil laws may and ought to keep aloof from divine and ecclesiastical au thority. — Ibid.

58. No other forces are to be recognized except those which reside in matter, and all

the rectitude and excellence of morality ought to be placed in the accumulation and increase of riches by every possible means, and the gratification of pleasure. — Ibid.; Encyclical "Quanta confidamur" Aug. 10, 1863.

59. Right consists in the material fact. All human duties are an empty word, and all hu man facts have the force of right. — Allocution ff Maxima quidem" June 9, 1862.

60. Authority is nothing else but numbers and the sum total of material forces. — Ibid.

61. The injustice of an act when success ful inflicts no injury on the sanctity of right.

—Allocution "lamdudum cernimus" March 18, 1861.

62. The principle of non-intervention, as it is called, ought to be proclaimed and ob served. — Allocution "Novos et ante" Sept. 28, 1860.

63. It is lawful to refuse obedience to legitimate princes, and even to rebel against them.— Encyclical ffQui pluribus" Nov. 9, 1864; Allocution "Quibusque vestrum" Oct. 1, 1847; "Noscitis et Nobiscum" Dec. 8, 1849; Letter Apostolic ffCum Catholica."

64. The violation of any solemn oath, as well as any wicked and flagitious action re pugnant to the eternal law, is not only not blamable but is altogether lawful and worthy of the highest praise when done through love of country. — Allocution "Quibus quantisque" April 20, 1849.

iVIII

ERRORS CONCERNING CHRISTIAN MARRIAGE

65. The doctrine that Christ has raised marriage to the dignity of a sacrament can not be at all tolerated. — Apostolic Letter "Ad Apostolicce" Aug. 22, 1851.

66. The Sacrament of Marriage is only a something accessory to the contract and sep arate from it, and the sacrament itself con sists in the nuptial benediction alone. — Ibid.

67. By the law of nature, the marriage tie is not indissoluble, and in many cases di vorce properly so called may be decreed by the civil authority. — Ibid.; Allocution " Acerbissi- mum" Sept. 27, 1852.

68. The Church has not the power of es-

tablishing diriment impediments of marriage, but such a power belongs to the civil author ity by which existing impediments are to be removed. — Damnatio ff Multiplies inter/' June 10, 1851.

69. In the dark ages the Church began to establish diriment impediments, not by her own right, but by using a power borrowed from the State. — Apostolic Letter (fAd Apos- toUcce" Aug. 22, 1851.

70. The canons of the Council of Trent, which anathematize those who dare to deny to the Church the right of establishing diriment impediments, either are not dogmatic, or must be understood as referring to such borrowed power. — Ibid.

71. The form of solemnizing marriage pre scribed by the Council of Trent, under pain of nullity, does not bind in cases where the civil law lays down anotker form, and declares that when this new form is used the marriage shall be valid. — Ibid.

72. Boniface VIII was the first who de clared that the vow of chastity taken at ordi nation renders marriage void. — Ibid.

73. In force of a merely civil contract there may exist

between Christians a real mar riage, and it is false to say either that the mar riage contract between Christians is always a sacrament, or that there is no contract if the sacrament be excluded. — Ibid.; Letter to the King of Sardinia, Sept. 9, 1852; Allocutions "Acerbissimum," Sept. 27, 1852; "Multis gravibusque," Dec. 17, 1860.

74. Matrimonial causes and espousals belong by their nature to civil tribunals. — En cyclical ffQui pluribus," Nov. 9, 1846; Dam- natio f 'Multiplies inter," June 10, 1851; cfAd Apostolica?" Aug. 22, 1851; Allocution "Acerbissimum," Sept. 27, 1852.

N. B. — To the preceding questions may be referred two other errors regarding the celib acy of priests and the preference due to the state of marriage over~tEar~of virginity. These have been stigmatized: the first in the Encyclical "Qui pluribus," Nov. 9, 1846; the second, in the Letter Apostolic "Multiplices inter," June 10, 1851.

IX

ERRORS REGARDING THE CIVIL POWER OF THE SOVEREIGN PONTIFF

75. The children of the Christian and Catholic Church are divided amongst them selves1 about the compatibility of the temporal with the spiritual power. — "Ad Apostolicce" 'Aug. 22, 1851.

76. The abolition of the temporal power of which the Apostolic See is possessed would contribute in the greatest degree to the lib erty and prosperity of the Church. — Allocu tions "Quibus quantisque" April 20, 1849; "Si semper antea" May 20, 1850.

N. B. — Besides these errors, explicitly cen sured, very many others are implicitly con demned by the doctrine propounded and es tablished, which all Catholics are bound most firmly to hold touching the temporal sover eignty of the Roman pontiff. This doctrine is clearly stated in the Allocutions "Quibus quantisque," April 20, 1849, and "Si semper

antea," May 20, 1850; Letter Apostolic "Cum Catholica ecclesia," March 26, 1860; Allocu tions, "Noves et antea," Sept. 28, 1860; "lamdudum cernimus," March 18, 1861; "Maxima quidem," June 9, 1862.

ERRORS HAVING REFERENCE TO MODERN LIBERALISM

77. In the present day it is no longer ex pedient that the Catholic religion should be held as the only religion of the State, to the exclusion of all other forms of worship. — Al locution "Nemo vestrum" July 26, '1855.

78. Hence it has been wisely decided by law, in some Catholic countries, that persons coming to reside therein shall enjoy the public exercise of their own peculiar worship. — Allo cution "Acerbissimum" Sept. 27, 1852.

79. Moreover, it is false that the civil lib erty of every form of worship, and the full power, given to all, of overtly and publicly manifesting any opinions whatsoever and

thoughts, conduce more easily to corrupt the morals and minds of the people, and to propa gate the pest of indirTerentism. — Allocution "Nunquam fore" Dec. 15, 1856.

80. The Roman Pontiff can, and ought to, reconcile himself, and come to terms with progress, liberalism and modern civilization. — Allocution "lamdudum cernimus" March 18, 1861.

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